

# Skills Summary

## Rounding and Ordering on the Number Line

*Use this reference while completing your worksheet or when studying.*

---

### Skill 1 — Rounding to the nearest ten

---

**Rule:** Put the number between its two neighbor tens on the line. The *ones* digit decides: 0–4 stays down, 5–9 goes up. Halfway (5 ones) always rounds *up*.

**Example:** Round 73 to the nearest ten.

**Step 1.** Trap 73 between its neighbor tens on the line: it sits between 70 and 80.

**Step 2.** The ones digit is three, before the halfway mark at seventy-five, so 73 is closer to 70.  $\Rightarrow$  **70**

**Try it:** Round 86 to the nearest ten.

check: 06

### Skill 2 — Rounding to the nearest hundred

---

**Rule:** Same line, bigger jumps: the neighbors are whole hundreds and the *tens* digit decides — 0–4 tens stays down, 5–9 tens goes up. The ones digit never gets a vote.

**Example:** Round 238 to the nearest hundred.

**Step 1.** Trap 238 between its neighbor hundreds, 200 and 300, with the halfway mark at two hundred fifty.

**Step 2.** The tens digit is three, so 238 sits before the halfway mark and stays down.  $\Rightarrow$  **200**

**Try it:** Round 561 to the nearest hundred.

check: 009

**(!) Watch out:** For the nearest hundred, read the *tens* digit. A number like 249 rounds *down* to 200 — its 9 ones cannot outvote the 4 tens.

---

### Skill 3 — Ordering numbers on a line

---

**Rule:** On a number line, *left is less* and *right is greater*. To order numbers, mark each one, then read the marks left to right. To place a mark, compare hundreds, then tens, then ones.

**Example:** Order least to greatest: 462, 426, 264.

**Step 1.** Mark by hundreds first: 264 has only two hundreds, so it sits far left of the other two.

**Step 2.** 462 and 426 tie at four hundreds; 426 has two tens and 462 has six tens, so 426 marks left of 462.  $\Rightarrow$  **264, 426, 462**

**Try it:** Order least to greatest: 519, 591, 159.

check: 159, 519, 591